



## Connecting to MySQL With Python and PHP

We all know the power of MySQL—one of the most used open source databases and a challenge to proprietary databases. Python and PHP are well-known scripting languages. We combine these two powers in this article. So fasten your seatbelts, and enjoy the ride!

As you know, there are many modules and APIs in Python. For databases, there is the DB-API, the database application programming interface. To use this API with MySQL, you need to have the *MySQLdb* driver. It's built into versions later than 2.3. You can also download it from <http://sourceforge.net/projects/mysql-python/> and install it with the following commands:

```
# tar -xvf foldername.tar.gz
# cd path-to-extracted-folder
#python setup.py install
```

**Note:** I am using Ubuntu 10.04 32-bit on my laptop, with Python 2.7 and PHP 5.3.2. So the data provided is with respect to this configuration.

Accessing MySQL through DB-API using *MySQLdb* comprises the following steps:

1. Import the *MySQLdb* module.
2. Open the connection to the server.
3. Run your queries.
4. Close the connection.

We will undertake these steps in a script *mysqlpython.py*:

```
import MySQLdb #1
connection=MySQLdb.connect(host="servername", #2
    user="username", passwd="password", db="databasename")
#2
cur=connection.cursor() #3
cur.execute("create table lfy(name varchar(40), author #4
    varchar(40))")
cur.execute("insert into lfy values('Foss Bytes','LFY Team')") #5
cur.execute("insert into lfy values('Connecting MySQL','Ankur #6
    Aggarwal')")
cur.execute("select * from lfy") #6
multiplerow=cur.fetchall() #7
print "Displaying All the Rows: ", multiplerow
print multiplerow[0]
cur.execute("select * from lfy")
row=cur.fetchone() #8
print "Displaying the first row: ", row
print "No of rows: ", cur.rowcount #9
cur.close() #10
connection.close() #11
```

A few notes with respect to the above code:

1. We imported the *MySQLdb* module to use the database API.